

once the scanner is in regular use, the scans are fast.

The scanner picked up minute details in the test photograph, such as wrinkles on the face and the texture on the fabric. The colour appeared a little brighter than in the original photograph. The scanner depicted all five colour blocks that were used for the resolution test at 1200 dpi. Generally in this test, most scanners depict the

difference between two lines up till four blocks and scan the fifth as a solid block. The scanner is expensive but the quality is top-notch and it is a silent operator.

SPECIFICATIONS:

1200x2400 dpi resolution; USB 1.1 interface; 48-bit depth; A4 size scan area

Benchmarks: 19.6 seconds preview time; 56.19 seconds to scan photograph in full colour mode at 300 dpi

Canon CanoScan		B-
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Features	★ ★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2	

Price: Rs 10,995

Contact: Canon India

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IBM NetVista A22P

Just right for Office

This is probably the fastest office application-oriented PC you'll find in the market. Powered by a P4, 1.5 GHz and 128 MB RAM, this machine isn't built for high-end graphics performance

it will take care of all your general office applications, accounting software and low-end graphics applications. In Content Creation Winstone 2001, it scored a trifle low at 42, indicating that its processor was being bottlenecked by the platform and memory subsystem. A score of 40 in this test should be considered the bare minimum. The machine's build quality is pretty decent and it comes bundled with Windows Me.

SPECIFICATIONS:

P4-1.5GHz; 128 MB RAM; Maxtor 20 GB IDE hard drive; E54 15-inch monitor

Benchmarks: 35.2 in Ziff-Davis Business Winstone 2002; 42 in ZD Content Creation Winstone 2002

IBM NetVista A22P		B
Performance	★ ★ ★	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★	

Price: Rs 51,999

Contact: IBM India

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Labtech Pulse-424

Sound, sweet sound

This speaker system is powered by two satellite speakers and one 8-inch subwoofer. The subwoofer was

amply powered but the satellite speakers proved to be the weak link as the size and performance of the satellites did

not seem to match with the sub. Installation was quite simple as the Labtech Pulse does not require any drivers or files to be installed. A handy little instruction manual shows the detailed procedure of connecting one colour-coded plug to a jack on the back of the subwoofer and another colour-coded plug to your PC's audio-out jack. Aesthetically speaking, the black coloured speakers might fascinate some users as they have a sleeker, aerodynamic look as opposed to the box shape of other speaker setups. We played a standard set of audio, MP3, VOB files and a DVD and found that the speakers were pretty decent in sound reproduction in all of these. Also, when tested with *Quake III*, the panning and firing sounds were all reproduced very well. There

Price: Rs 4,200

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was minimal distortion at higher frequencies and the speaker setup held itself well at higher volumes except for the fact that you sometimes felt the lack of a little more 'twang' at the higher end of the frequency spectrum.

Overall, this speaker system would be ideal for those who like an excellent 2.1 speaker setup. However, for a 2.1 setup, Rs 4,200 it is a bit too much.

SPECIFICATIONS:

3 speakers; 20 Watts RMS subwoofers; 32 Watts RMS power output; power supply: internal

Labtech Pulse-424		B
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ 1/2	
Value for Money	★ ★ ★	
Features	★ ★ ★	
OVERALL	★ ★ ★	

Napa DAV315

Delivers what it promises

The most economical and reliable bet in CD MP3 players yet. For the price that this player comes at, you can't get anything even remotely as good in India. The Napa DAV315 is a portable MP3-CD-Player with a 120 second skip buffer that actually works, and works very well too. It even survived a real trek without a single skip, so you can be sure that it won't skip during your regular Sunday morning jog. It will not fit into your pocket but comes with a carrying strap that attaches firmly to the MP3 player, letting you hang it comfortably around your neck.

The bundled earphones aren't too good—this one is not powerful enough to drive our AKG K44 reference head-



phones to their full potential—but they don't disappoint when used with standard Philips earphones. The player is crisp on mids and highs but a little low on bass. This can be attributed more to the earphones rather than the player. The Napa reads all possible MP3 formats including VBR MP3s, and from all CD media, ranging from CD-Rs to RWs and even CDs burnt using multiple sessions. There are five preset equalisers available, but they are better left